

Electricity (continues)

Loadshedding

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Definition:

- It is the periodical shutdown of electricity by ESKOM.

Cause of loadshedding

It is when insufficient power station capacity to supply the demand(load) from all the customers, the electricity system becomes unbalanced which can cause it to trip out (blackout) and which could take days to restore.

Stages of loadshedding

Stage 1

- It requires the least amount of loadshedding 3 times over a day period 2 hours at 3 times over an 8 day period for 4 hours at a time.

Stage 2

- It allows for up to 2000 Mega-watts at the national load to be shed and it doubles the frequency of Stage 1

Stage 3

- It allows for up to 3000 Mega-watts at the national load to be shed.

Stage 4

- It allows for up to 4000 Mega-watts at the national load to be shed.

Stage 5

- It allows for up to 5000 Mega-watts at the national load to be shed.

Stage 6

- It allows for up to 6000 Mega-watts at the national load to be shed.

